My own response to an artist teacher and cover plan

BUILD Spring 1 Week 3 Tuesday 19 January 2027 P1 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Find out about an artist who expresses feelings.

Today: I can link my own art to an artist's idea.

Success criteria

I can recall two facts about the artist.

I can make my own piece using a new layout.

I can say how the artist's idea helped me.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For four pupils: four real trial sets, four books or arts logs, four pencils and eight small scrap pieces for fresh trials if needed.

Paper route: twelve pupil-owned torn shapes or scrap to tear, four small bases, four mats and two glue sticks. Shapes can stay loose until a layout is chosen. No cutting tool is required.

Drawing route: four sets of familiar drawing tools. Optional paint uses five brushes, four mats, two stable water pots, a little washable paint and cloths.

Adult model: three original shapes and a new layout based on the method of trying arrangements. The artist card is read aloud; no actual artwork is displayed or copied.

Quiet sound needs only fingertips; the materials-free route uses silent hand positions, pupil-directed adult movement or an original spoken description. Keep four individual storage places and a flat drying area.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0 to 15 seconds: Point to two facts from the artist description. Say: He cut painted paper and moved shapes. That helps me think about a method.

15 to 30 seconds: Move three own torn shapes into a new path. Say: I test my own layout for an invented feeling of hope.

30 to 45 seconds: Keep or change a gap and fix only when chosen. Or show a silent low-middle-high hand sequence. Say: My choices and this new design are my own.

45 to 60 seconds: Point to the actual response. Say: The artist's idea helped me test a layout. I keep that link and my own reason in my log.

Arrival and starter

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Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: Find your real trials from last time. Listen to the artist card again if needed. Tell or show one fact and your chosen layout.

What to say: Find your own tests. If you were away or the tests are missing, hear the short card and make a quick fresh trial now. We use today's real date. Matisse is the artist; the new response will belong to you. You may use an invented feeling and share privately.

What good looks like: The pupil identifies an actual prior choice or makes an honest catch-up trial, and recalls an artist detail with rereading if needed.

Materials free fallback: Read the card aloud and offer three silent hand positions close, then apart. The pupil chooses one or directs a new layout.

Check and response: A fresh trial and a reread card are valid. Do not invent a previous piece, quotation or pupil response.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: Which are facts from the artist card? Cut painted paper. Moved the shapes. Does a shape tell us the artist's private mood?

What to say: Ask the pupil to name or point to two facts: cut painted paper and moved shapes. Then ask whether our description tells us exactly how he felt. A viewer can have a personal reading while being honest about what the facts show.

What good looks like: The pupil identifies or confirms two accurate method details and knows that the description does not prove a private emotional state.

Materials free fallback: Give one spoken fact at a time and use an agreed yes or no gesture. Allow the pupil to listen again before responding.

Check and response: Both method details are facts in the card. No, a shape alone does not tell us the artist's private mood. Reread and model one fact versus one personal reading if needed.

Modelling and cover guidance

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I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Watch the adult use an artist's idea in a new way. Move three own shapes. Choose a new layout. Make a small piece for a made-up feeling. Say what is the artist link and what is your own choice.

What to say: Matisse's method of trying arrangements helped me. I use my own three torn shapes and move them into a rising path. I choose this layout for an invented feeling of hope. My shapes and layout are my own design. I may draw round them or use a little glue under each shape once I choose. I do not recreate an existing composition. In a silent response I can place three hand shapes low, middle and high. I explain the method link without pretending the artist made my piece.

What good looks like: The adult makes an original short response and clearly separates a general borrowed method from the new subject, shapes, arrangement and interpretation.

Materials free fallback: Use or direct three silent hand shapes at different heights, or describe their order. A pupil who prefers stillness can make every choice verbally.

Check and response: Ask: 'Which came from learning about the artist: moving shapes to test a layout, or my exact new shape path?' Expected: the method of testing a layout. The exact path is the adult's own example.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Read the task and make two tiny tests in paint, sound or silent hand movement. Let pupils choose a feature and make a short response. Use the same timings and log prompts. No specialist demonstration is needed. If prior work is missing, use a fresh trial with today's date.

Guided practice and task

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We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Help make one new class response. Choose a layout and a made-up feeling. Check the artist link and our own choices. Finish: The artist's idea helped us ___.

What to say: You direct our original shapes. We can change spacing, line or position for our own idea. Hinge: Which is an honest log: A 'I made the artist's real work', or B 'I tried moving my own shapes after hearing about his method'? Ask why the record is honest.

What good looks like: The pupil makes an intentional new choice and distinguishes an original response from a copied or falsely attributed artwork.

Materials free fallback: Use a pupil-directed silent sequence or spoken layout. Ask the same A or B question orally and let the pupil confirm a choice.

Check and response: B is honest. If a pupil chooses A, point out the different maker, shapes and layout. Parallel check: 'Can I write my own name or code on my own response and name the artist as the idea link?' Expected: yes. Continue when the pupil can identify the method link and their own choice.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: In your book or arts log, use your real test. Make a small piece with your own shapes or moves. Choose a layout for a made-up feeling. Check one part. Keep or change it for a reason. Add the artist link and your own words.

What to say: Use your selected trial or choose a fresh layout and record why. For paper art, move three own torn shapes before fixing. Use a little glue underneath, press gently on the mat and keep fingers clear of wet paint. Drawing is equally valid. For a sound response, choose three soft taps with your own pauses and order; the link is testing spacing in your own form. Keep sound below talking volume and stop on a raised hand. A small piece is enough. An adult may handle materials under the pupil's direction. The pupil decides the feeling, layout and review.

What good looks like: A real original response, two accurate artist details recalled with support if needed, and a clear link from the artist's general method to a pupil-owned feature. The log distinguishes intention and observation. Record unfinished work honestly rather than claiming a final piece.

Materials free fallback: Make or direct a silent layout or movement response, or give an original spoken description. The adult records the actual ordered actions, the pupil's stated emotion, artist link and decision when a recording method is available.

Check and response: Example only: I moved my own shapes, as the description said the artist could do. My layout rises because I chose hope. I kept the space at the end because it seems open to me. A different reason or art form is valid.

Review and evidence

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Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Show an adult or partner your own response. Name the artist and the idea that helped you. Say: My own choice was ___ because ___. Tidy and keep the response with your log.

What to say: Ask for the artist link and a choice in the actual response. A listener can notice a feature and offer a different reading. The maker decides what to keep. Sharing can be private. Use the last two minutes to cap glue, return tools, collect scraps and store work flat. Keep the real response, trials and log together.

What good looks like: The pupil explains a method link and a personal choice without claiming the class models or their response are works by the artist. Tools and evidence are stored safely.

Materials free fallback: Witness a silent response privately and read a short factual description back for the pupil to confirm. Keep the pupil's interpretation separate from the adult's observed actions.

Check and response: A useful review is 'The artist moved shapes to test a layout. I moved my own shapes apart because I wanted calm.' It does not need to tell a personal life story.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Arts log: The artist is ___. I found out ___ and ___. The artist's idea helped me ___. My own choice was ___ because ___.

What to say: Keep the artist facts and the response in their proper roles. Ask the pupil what they found out and how it helped their own work. Scribe exact words if needed, read them back and allow correction. Use the actual date, help used and true state of the work. This entry contributes to the ongoing Explore log.

What good looks like: A dated log gives or confirms the artist name, two facts, an original response or witnessed sequence, and a method link with a personal choice and reason. No quotation or model answer is passed off as pupil evidence.

Materials free fallback: Take an oral log with agreed gestures or a spoken description. The adult records only the actual confirmed facts, response and pupil words at the next recording opportunity.

Check and response: Example only: The artist is Henri Matisse. He cut painted paper and moved shapes. His idea helped me test a layout. I chose a rising path because it suggests hope to me.

Access and teaching decisions

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Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the task and skill words aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

An original response must look like the artist's actual work - Borrow a general method such as testing a layout, then use the pupil's own shapes, arrangement, subject and reason.

The teacher decides the feeling in the pupil's piece - The maker names or confirms the intended emotion. An adult supports access and records the pupil's own explanation.

The log can describe work that we meant to make - Retain actual work or a precise witness note. State the true stage and next step; do not invent a finished piece or earlier trial.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.